

Wazuh Security Investigation Report

Investigation Platform: Wazuh

Environment: Windows & Linux endpoints

Investigation Date: 20 August 2026

Analyst: Basith

1. Investigation Overview

This investigation was conducted using Wazuh to identify and analyze suspicious security activity across a Windows endpoint and a Linux endpoint.

The investigation focused on four major areas:

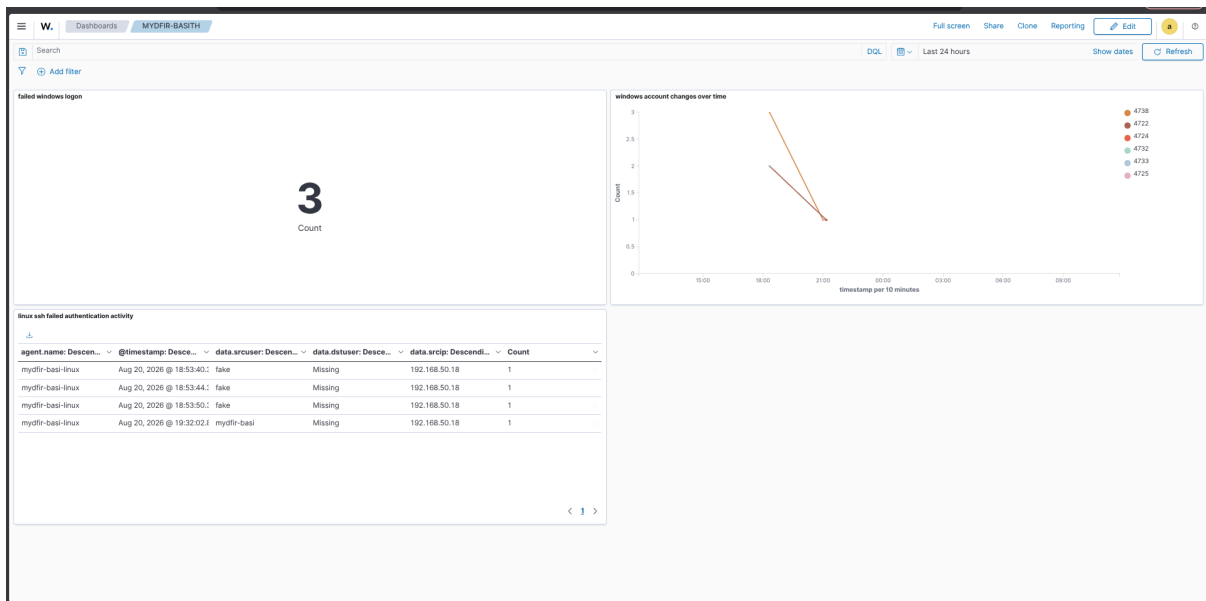
- Windows account activity
- Windows File Integrity Monitoring (FIM)
- Linux File Integrity Monitoring (FIM)
- SSH authentication activity

The investigation identified a combination of account modification, file modification, file deletion, and repeated SSH authentication failures.

The most significant detection was the enabling of the Windows Guest account, which triggered a custom Wazuh rule specifically created for this investigation

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MYDFIR – Basith : Wazuh Security Monitoring Dashboard



- Failed Windows logons
- Windows account changes
- Linux SSH failed authentication activity

2. Questions Driving the Investigation

The investigation was guided by the following questions:

- What happened?
- When did it happen?
- Which hosts were involved?
- Which accounts were changed?
- Was a file deleted?
- Was SSH abuse observed?
- What should be recommended?

3. Findings

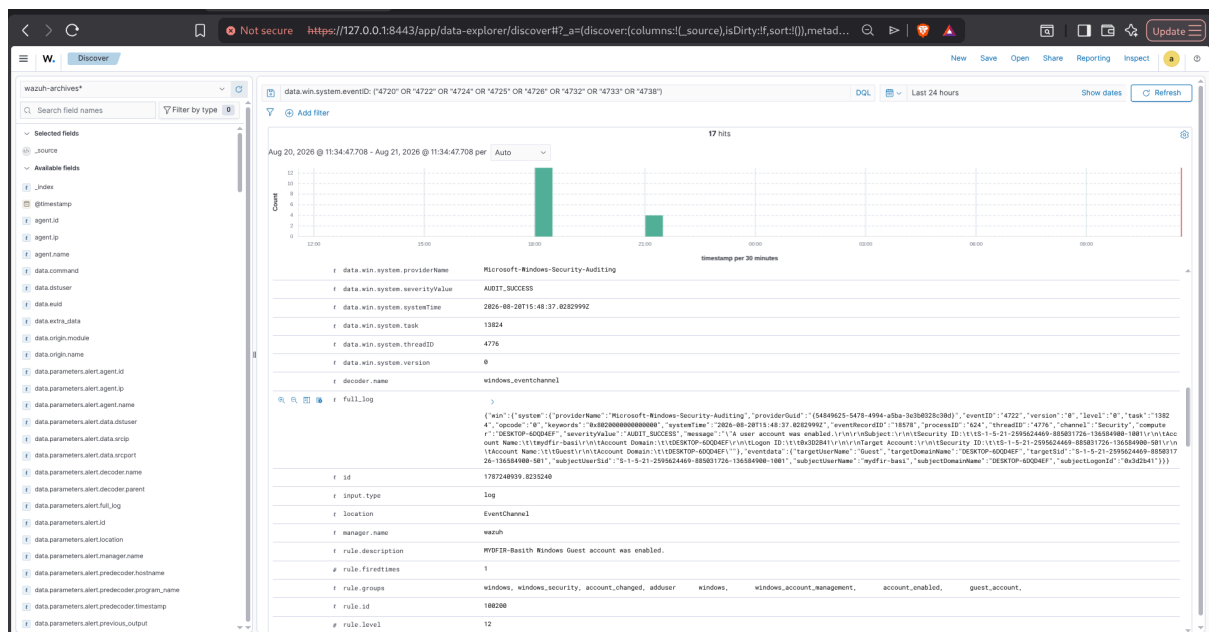
Finding 3.1 – Windows Guest Account Was Enabled

Wazuh detected that the built-in Guest account was enabled on the Windows endpoint.

Evidence

- Host: mydfir-basi (Windows)
- IP: 192.168.50.18
- Target account: Guest
- Account SID: S-1-5-21-2595624469-885031726-136584900-501
- Account that performed the action: mydfir-basi (Windows)
- Windows Event ID: 4722
- Custom Wazuh Rule: 100200
- Rule Level: 12
- Rule Description: MYDFIR-Basith Windows Guest account was enabled.
- MITRE ATT&CK: T1078 - Valid Accounts
- Event status: AUDIT_SUCCESS
- Event time: 20 August 2026, approximately 21:18 IST

The Windows Security event confirms that the Guest account was enabled successfully.



4. Windows File Integrity Monitoring

Finding 4.1 – Windows File Was Modified

Wazuh File Integrity Monitoring detected a modification to:

C:\companydata\payroll.txt

Evidence

- Host: mydfir-basi(Windows)
- IP: 192.168.50.18
- File: C:\companydata\payroll.txt
- Event: modified
- Detection: Integrity checksum changed
- Wazuh Rule: 550
- Rule Level: 7
- Monitoring Mode: realtime

The file changed from:

- Original size: 15 bytes
- New size: 18 bytes

The cryptographic hashes also changed.

MD5

Before:

04dce1d74ec9e07b4c1cde606fea4082

After:

7b5ec6d6c6ed0a2f85634117f4aa9456

SHA1

Before:

e7f823dd9347826f4b3a72f66616d17a4e8d7c19

After:

4035497ccf23e443988d88a2e9a847e1c786ca5b

SHA256

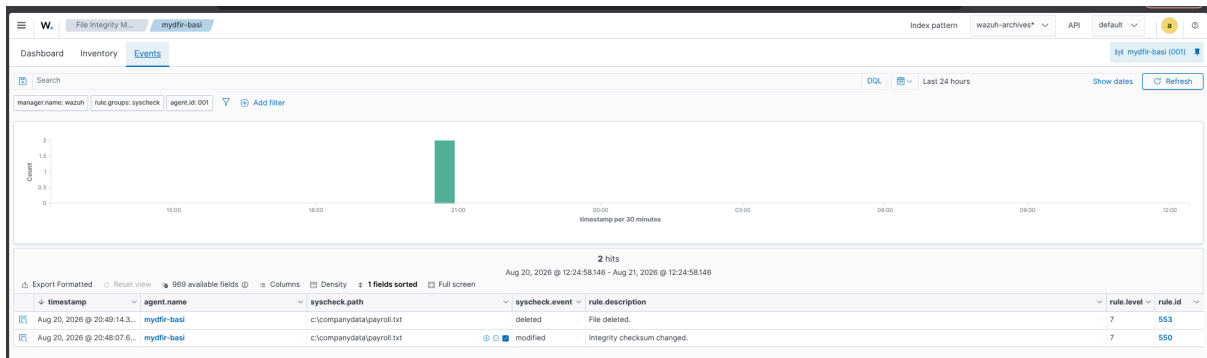
Before:

59bcf4f456c4d7592763c6543596612457dd6025f11d21eedebf939dae4a8d63

After:

c8112e80b3a72587b677913d4b717142e2eb579c226eac7d6696111f0a7b0d5

The change occurred at approximately 20:48 IST.



Finding 4.2 – Windows File Was Deleted

Shortly after the modification, Wazuh detected that the same file was deleted:

C:\companydata\payroll.txt

Evidence

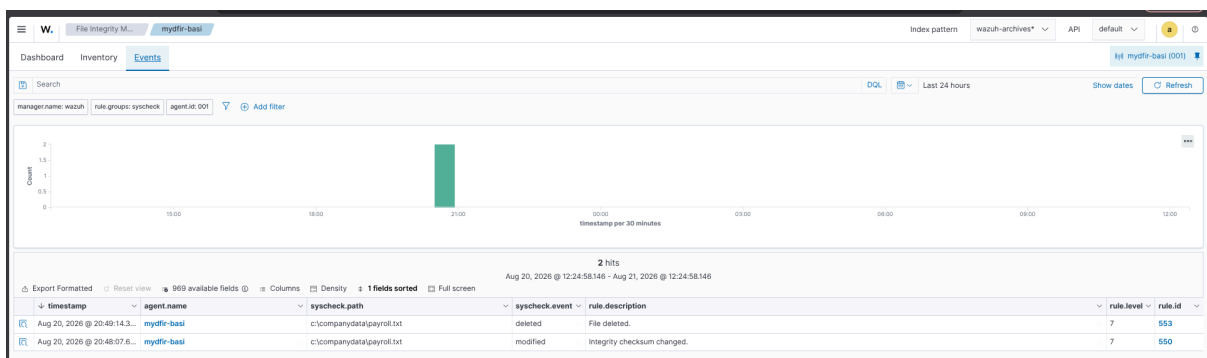
- Event: **deleted**
- Rule: **553**
- Rule Level: **7**
- Detection: **File deleted**
- Monitoring Mode: **realtime**
- Host: **mydfir-basi (Windows)**
- Time: approximately 20:49 IST

The sequence of events was therefore:

File modified → File integrity changed → File deleted

The deletion was mapped by Wazuh to:

- MITRE ATT&CK T1070.004 – File Deletion
- MITRE ATT&CK T1485 – Data Destruction



5. Linux File Integrity Monitoring

Finding 5.1 – Linux File Was Modified

Wazuh detected a modification to:

`/opt/company-data/text.txt`

Evidence

- Host: `mydfir-basi1-linux`
- IP: `192.168.50.15`
- File: `/opt/company-data/text.txt`
- Event: `modified`
- Detection: `Integrity checksum changed`
- Rule: `550`
- Rule Level: `7`
- Monitoring Mode: `realtime`

The file changed from:

8 bytes → 12 bytes

The cryptographic hashes also changed.

MD5

Before:

`43fccfba6702c5f9711cf9bd3190eb97`

After:

`d3d54e4a31b69cd78fc9b5d1ffc0b850`

SHA1

Before:

`9fd8544cce14b9799c828d598d913ce0bf364776`

After:

`a381e23aeeb962daeb3e92005580d7bbaa6cd52c`

SHA256

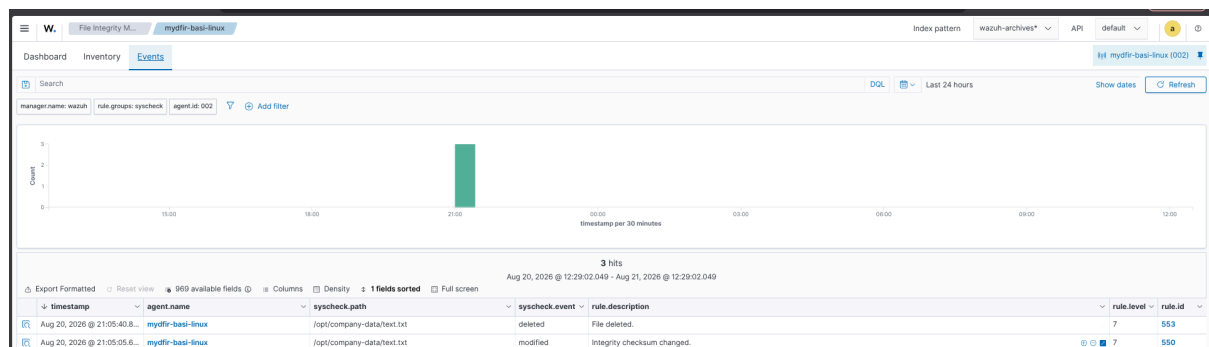
Before:

ba821ff9f2bc189b2584b1327d24fa74fedb55ffbb1e777f604733c7b70aeda8

After:

7068f51ddc15ba5a52f28add3612e75dd0598dcbe12aa4bbceee91d198b5218c

The modification was detected at approximately 21:05 IST.



Finding 5.2 – Linux File Was Deleted

Wazuh subsequently detected deletion of:

/opt/company-data/text.txt

Evidence

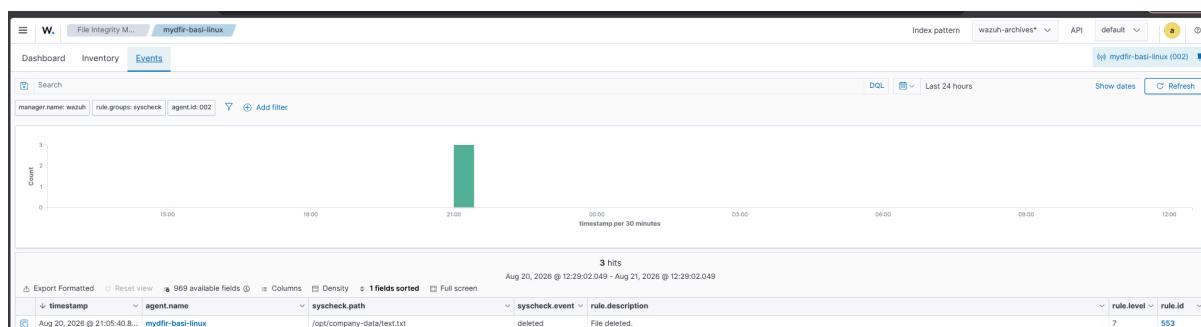
- Event: **deleted**
- Rule: **553**
- Rule Level: **7**
- Monitoring Mode: **realtime**
- Host: **mydfir-basi1-linux**
- Time: approximately 21:05 IST

The Linux sequence was:

File modified → Hashes changed → File deleted

Wazuh mapped the deletion to:

- **T1070.004 – File Deletion**
- **T1485 – Data Destruction**



6. SSH Authentication Activity

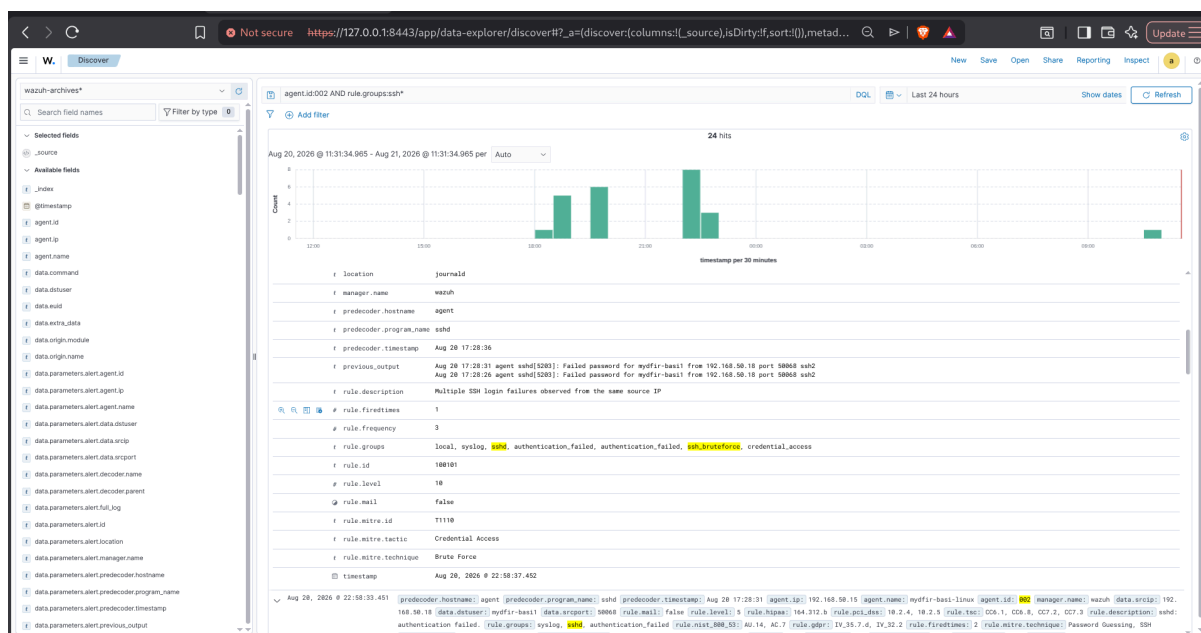
Finding 6.1 – Multiple SSH Login Failures Were Detected

Wazuh detected repeated failed SSH authentication attempts against the Linux endpoint.

Evidence

- Source IP: **192.168.50.18**
- Source host: **mydfir-basi (Windows)**
- Destination host: **mydfir-basi1-(linux)**
- Destination IP: **192.168.50.15**
- Target account: **mydfir-basi1-(linux)**
- Source port: **50068**
- Wazuh Rule: **100101**
- Rule Level: **10**
- Rule Frequency: **3**
- Rule Description: **Multiple SSH login failures observed from the same source IP**
- MITRE ATT&CK: **T1110 – Brute Force**

The Wazuh alert shows three failed password attempts from the same source IP.



7. Investigation Summary

The investigation identified several security-relevant events across the Windows and Linux endpoints.

The first major finding was the successful enablement of the Windows Guest account. The action was performed by the **mydfir-basi** (Windows) account and generated the custom Wazuh rule 100200, with a severity level of 12.

File Integrity Monitoring then identified changes to monitored files on both endpoints.

On Windows, **C:\companydata\payroll.txt** was modified. Its size and cryptographic hashes changed, and the file was subsequently deleted.

A similar sequence occurred on Linux. **/opt/company-data/text.txt** was modified, its size and hashes changed, and it was subsequently deleted.

The investigation also identified repeated failed SSH authentication attempts originating from the Windows endpoint **192.168.50.18** against the Linux endpoint **192.168.50.15**. Wazuh correlated three failed attempts and generated custom rule 100101, identifying potential brute-force activity.

The evidence demonstrates that Wazuh successfully detected activity across account management, file integrity, file deletion, and authentication monitoring.

8. Who, What, When, Where, Why, How

Who – Who was involved?

The primary hosts involved were:

Windows

Hostname	Mydfir-basi (Windows)
IP	192.168.50.18

The Windows account involved in the account-management event was:

mydfir-basi(Window)

The account that was enabled was:

Guest

Linux

Hostname	mydfir-basi1-linux
IP	192.168.50.15

The SSH activity targeted the Linux host and attempted authentication against:

mydfir-basi1

The SSH attempts originated from:

192.168.50.18

What – What happened

The investigation identified four major types of activity:

1. The Windows **Guest account** was enabled.
2. A Windows monitored file was **modified and deleted**.
3. A Linux monitored file was **modified and deleted**.
4. Multiple failed **SSH authentication attempts** were observed.

These activities were detected and correlated by Wazuh.

When – When did this occur?

The activity occurred on **20 August 2026**.

All report times are presented in **IST (UTC+05:30)** based on the Wazuh `@timestamp` values provided.

Event	Approximate Time
Windows <code>payroll.txt</code> modified	20:48 IST
Windows <code>payroll.txt</code> deleted	20:49 IST
Linux <code>text.txt</code> modified	21:05 IST
Linux <code>text.txt</code> deleted	21:05 IST
Windows Guest account enabled	21:18 IST
SSH brute-force alert	22:58 IST

Based on the evidence provided, there is **no evidence confirming that the activity continued after the observed events**.

Where – Where did this happen

The activity occurred across two monitored endpoints.

Windows Endpoint

Host	Mydfir-basi (Windows)
IP	192.168.50.18

Affected file:

C:\companydata\payroll.txt

Security log:

Windows Security Event ID 4722

Linux Endpoint

Host	mydfir-basi1-linux
IP	192.168.50.15
Affected file:	/opt/company-data/text.txt
Authentication service:	SSH / sshd

Why – Why did this happen?

The exact reason cannot be determined from the available Wazuh evidence alone.

The activity may represent authorized testing within the lab environment, but from a security-monitoring perspective, the following actions are suspicious and require validation:

- Enabling the Guest account
- Modifying monitored files
- Deleting monitored files
- Repeated SSH authentication failures

The Guest account event is particularly important because enabling a normally disabled account can increase the available attack surface.

The file changes and deletions may indicate unauthorized modification or removal of data, although the available evidence does not establish the attacker's intent.

How – How did this happen?

The observed activity occurred through several different mechanisms:

Windows Account Activity

The Windows Security subsystem recorded **Event ID 4722**, indicating that the Guest account was enabled.

Wazuh collected the event through **Windows EventChannel** monitoring and matched it against custom rule **100200**.

File Modification and Deletion

Wazuh File Integrity Monitoring operated in **realtime mode**.

When the monitored files changed, Wazuh detected differences in:

- File size
- Modification time
- MD5
- SHA1
- SHA256

When the files were subsequently removed, Wazuh generated file-deletion alerts.

SSH Activity

The Linux **sshd** service recorded multiple failed password authentication attempts from **192.168.50.18**.

Wazuh correlated the repeated failures and generated custom rule **100101**, identifying the behavior as potential brute-force activity under **MITRE ATT&CK T1110**.

9.Recommendations

1. **Disable the Guest account** unless it is explicitly required.
2. **Review the mydfir-basi (Windows) account activity** and confirm the Guest account change was authorized.
3. **Investigate the modified and deleted files** and restore them from a trusted backup if required.
4. **Review the failed SSH attempts** and verify whether the activity was authorized.
5. **Strengthen SSH security** by using key-based authentication and restricting SSH access to trusted hosts.
6. **Continue Wazuh FIM and custom-rule monitoring** for account changes, file modifications, deletions, and authentication attacks.

Maintain Custom Wazuh Detection Rules

The custom rules successfully identified important activity that could otherwise be difficult to notice.

The following rules should remain enabled:

Rule	Purpose	Level
100200	Windows Guest account enabled	12
100101	Multiple SSH login failures	10
550	File integrity changed	7
553	File deleted	7

10. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Activity	MITRE ATT&CK	Technique
Guest account enabled	T1078	Valid Accounts
SSH authentication failures	T1110	Brute Force
Windows file deletion	T1070.004	File Deletion
Linux file deletion	T1070.004	File Deletion
File/data destruction activity	T1485	Data Destruction
File modification	T1565.001	Stored Data Manipulation

11. Evidence Summary

The following Wazuh evidence was collected during the investigation:

Evidence	Host	Result
Custom Guest account alert	Mydfir-basi (Windows)	Guest account enabled
Windows FIM	mydfir-basi(Windows)	payroll.txt modified
Windows FIM	Mydfir-basi (Windows)	payroll.txt deleted

Linux FIM	mydfir-basi1-linux	text.txt modified
Linux FIM	mydfir-basi1-linux	text.txt deleted
SSH monitoring	mydfir-basi1-linux	Multiple failed SSH logins

Conclusion

The investigation successfully identified multiple security-relevant events across the Windows and Linux endpoints. Wazuh detected the **Windows Guest account being enabled, modification and deletion of monitored files**, and **repeated SSH authentication failures**.

The custom Wazuh rules and File Integrity Monitoring provided effective visibility into these activities. The events should be reviewed to confirm whether they were authorized and to reduce the risk of unauthorized account access, data modification, file deletion, and SSH abuse.

End of Report